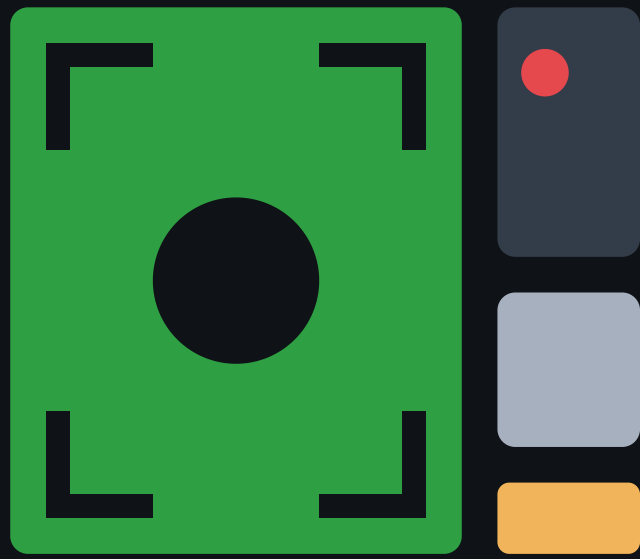


USER GUIDE

RecLink

Set up and use the camera bridge for your Betaflight quad: wiring, pairing, recording control, OSD and the web configurator.

Firmware 0.2.0 (pre-release) · Betaflight 2025.12+ · GoPro HERO 9–13 · DJI Osmo (experimental)

CONTENTS

Everything in this guide

1 What RecLink is and what it never does

2 What you need

3 Wiring to the flight controller

4 Betaflight setup

5 First power-up and the web configurator

6 Pairing your camera

7 Reading the Status tab

8 Recording control

9 Zones: camera settings from a switch

10 OSD: camera info in your goggles

11 Clock sync, GPS push and highlight tags

12 Network, System, firmware updates

13 Flying with RecLink

14 Troubleshooting

A Reference: tokens, defaults, LEDs, button

READ FIRST: PRE-RELEASE STATUS

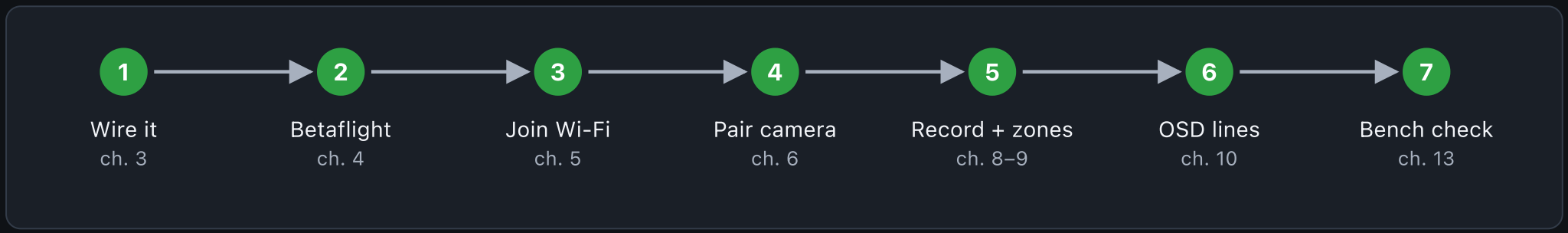
This firmware (0.2.0) has been bench-tested on a custom ESP32-C3 board wired to a Betaflight flight controller and a GoPro HERO11 Black. It has **not been flight tested**, and some camera protocol values are still being verified against live captures. Treat every flight as a test flight. Do all setup and testing on the bench **with propellers removed**, and check every behaviour in this guide before you fly with it.

PASSENGER, NOT PILOT

RecLink only **reads** from your flight controller and **writes OSD text**. It cannot arm, disarm, move motors, change PIDs or touch the radio link. That boundary is enforced in the firmware itself, not left to convention. If RecLink fails, the worst thing that can happen in flight is that the OSD text stops updating.

How to read this guide

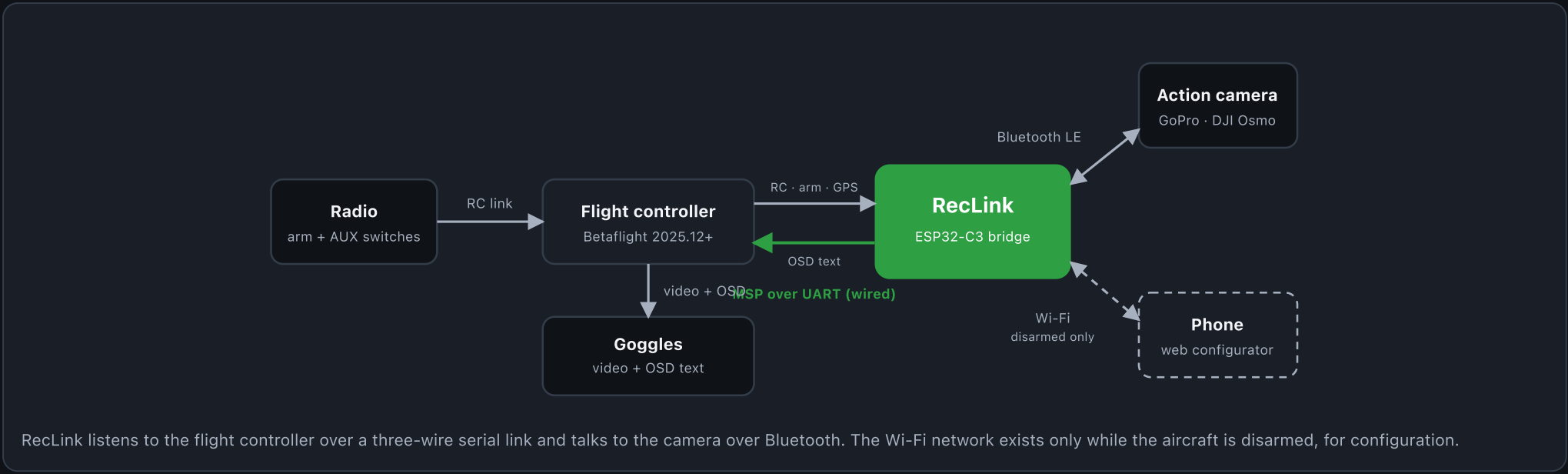
Chapters 1–6 take you from a bare board to a paired camera and are meant to be followed in order. Chapters 7–12 explain each part of the web configurator. Chapters 13 and 14 cover day-to-day use and what to do when something is wrong. Screenshots show the real configurator on a phone.



CHAPTER 1

What RecLink is

A small ESP32 board that sits between your flight controller and your action camera, so the camera is controlled by the aircraft and reports back on your OSD.



RecLink listens to the flight controller over a three-wire serial link and talks to the camera over Bluetooth. The Wi-Fi network exists only while the aircraft is disarmed, for configuration.

What it does

- **Camera info on the OSD.** Recording state, elapsed and remaining time, camera battery, SD space, resolution, frame rate and link status, as 22 tokens across four 16-character lines you design yourself.
- **Recording that follows the aircraft.** Start and stop on arm, on a radio switch, or on a combination. Every command is checked against what the camera reports.
- **Camera settings from a switch.** A 2–6 position switch or knob selects zones. On a GoPro each zone pushes its own resolution, frame rate, lens, HyperSmooth and Protune values. On a DJI each zone selects a camera mode.
- **Highlight tags** from a momentary switch (GoPro HiLight, DJI Quick-Switch).
- **Up to four paired cameras**, any mix of GoPro and DJI. At power-up it connects to the strongest one in range.
- **Clock sync** from the flight controller's GPS time, so footage carries the right timestamp.
- **One web page** for all configuration, plus firmware updates. No app, no cloud.

What it never does

HARD LIMITS

- Never sends RC, GPS, clock, display or reboot commands to the flight controller, and never changes its configuration.
- Never arms or disarms the aircraft.
- Never runs Wi-Fi while armed. The access point is shut down within 100 ms of arming.
- Never powers the camera, and never formats a card or deletes files from automation.
- Never shows a value the camera has not confirmed. An unknown value renders blank, not `0` and not a guess.

Supported hardware

ITEM	SUPPORTED	LINK
Flight controller	Betaflight 2025.12.0 or newer (MSP API 1.47+). Older versions cannot show custom OSD messages.	MSP over a spare UART
GoPro	HERO 9, 10, 11, 12, 13, and newer models that use the same Open GoPro Bluetooth API (HERO11 Black is the one bench-tested; Mission 1 is expected but unverified)	Bluetooth LE
DJI	**Experimental, unverified:** Osmo Action 4, 5 Pro and 6, Osmo Nano, Osmo 360 (no DJI camera has been tested yet)	Bluetooth LE
OSD	Analog and digital. Digital mode limits output to the glyphs DJI-style goggles can draw.	via the FC

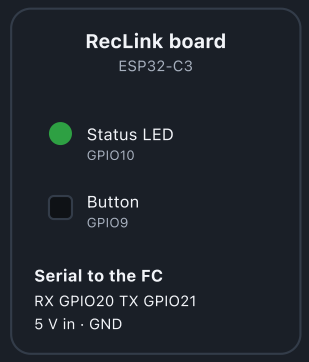
CHAPTER 2

What you need

A RecLink board, a free UART on your flight controller, and a camera that is on its own power.

CHECKLIST

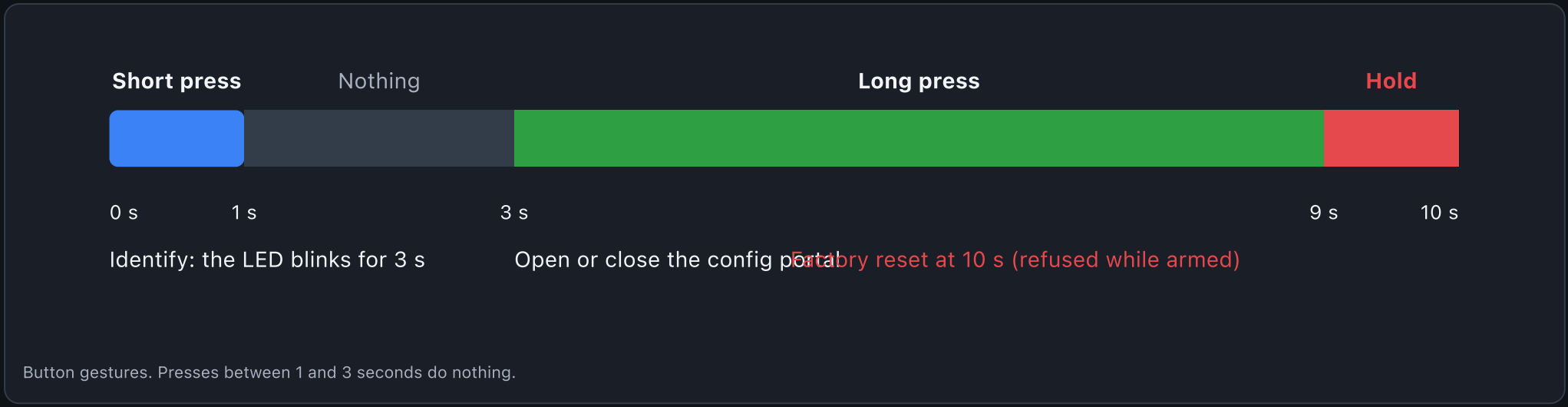
- RecLink board (ESP32-C3) with its harness.
- Flight controller running **Betaflight 2025.12.0 or newer**, with an OSD chip or HD OSD working.
- A **free UART** on the FC with its TX, RX, 5 V and GND pads accessible.
- A supported camera, charged, with an SD card.
- A radio with at least one free AUX channel (two or three if you want record, zones and highlight).
- A phone or laptop with Wi-Fi to run the configurator.
- A bulk capacitor of at least **220 µF** across the board's 5 V input, if your board does not already have one.
- For firmware updates: a computer and the `.bin` file.



Controls and pins on the production board.

Know your two controls

The board has one **button** and one **status LED**. They are all you need when the portal is closed, and every gesture works only while the board is running. Nothing is read at power-up.

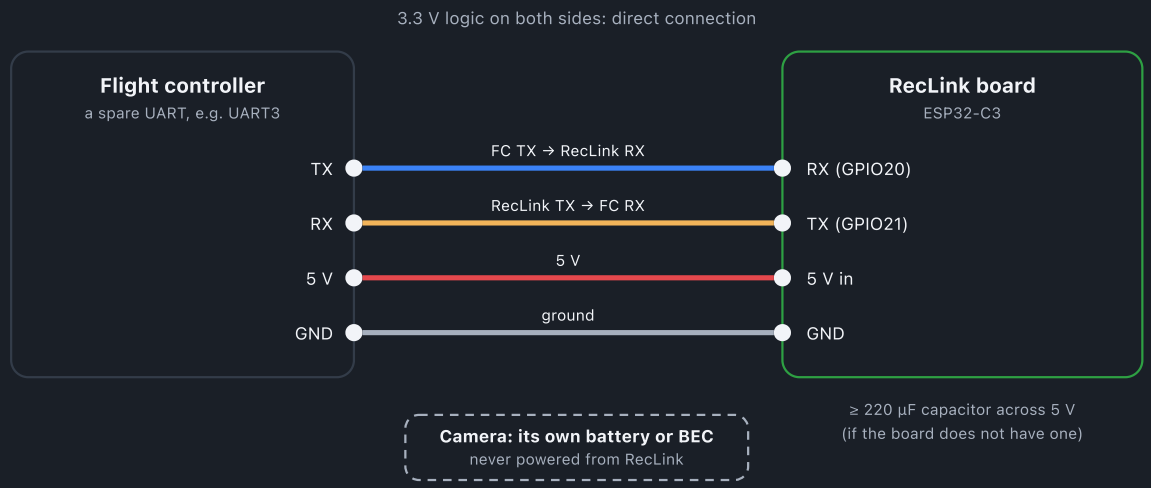


Button gestures. Presses between 1 and 3 seconds do nothing.

CHAPTER 3

Wiring to the flight controller

Four wires: two for serial data, two for power. The serial link is 3.3 V logic on both sides, so connect it directly with no level shifter.



Serial wires cross: the FC's TX goes to RecLink's RX, and RecLink's TX goes to the FC's RX.

1. **Pick a free UART on the flight controller** and note its number. You will enable MSP on that UART in chapter 4.
2. **Connect the four wires** as drawn. The board's TX line has a 470 Ω series resistor on the board. Do not add another.
3. **Add the capacitor if needed.** Bluetooth and Wi-Fi transmit bursts draw about 350 mA peaks. On a long thin harness this can pull the supply down and reset the board. A 220 µF or larger low-ESR capacitor across the 5 V pads prevents that.
4. **Mount it close to the camera.** Keep the board's antenna clear of carbon fibre and battery leads. Bluetooth range to the camera is the part that suffers from bad placement.
5. **Leave the camera's power alone.** The camera runs from its own battery or BEC. RecLink never powers or biases it.

CROSSED THE WIRES? NO NEED TO RESOLDER

If TX and RX end up swapped on a four-pin harness, you can fix it in the configurator: **Network → Swap TX/RX pins** (advanced mode), then reboot. See chapter 12.

POWER

The board takes 5 V from the flight controller through its onboard regulator. Check that the pad you use is 5 V and not battery voltage before you connect. The board has a brown-out detector: a dip in supply resets it and it recovers on its own within about 300 ms, but the OSD text freezes for that moment.

CHAPTER 4

Betaflight setup

Two changes in Betaflight Configurator: turn on MSP on the UART you wired, and make four custom message elements visible on the OSD.

USE THE LATEST BETAFLIGHT CONFIGURATOR

You need **Betaflight firmware 2025.12.0 or newer** on the flight controller, and the **latest Betaflight Configurator** on your computer. The screenshots in this guide were taken with Configurator **2026.6.2**. Use the web app at `app.betaflight.com` (in Chrome or Edge) or install the newest desktop version. An older Configurator may not offer the Custom message elements.

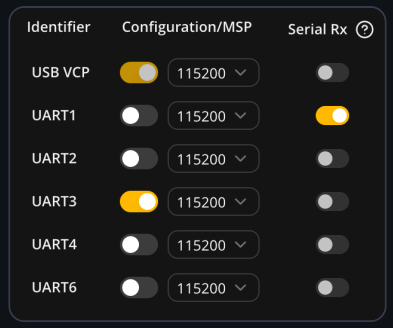
VERSION CHECK

Custom OSD messages exist only in **Betaflight 2025.12.0 and newer** (MSP API 1.47 or higher). They were not added to older versions. If your firmware is older, update it first. RecLink reports "FC too old for custom OSD" if it detects an older API.

1. Enable MSP on the UART

1. Connect the flight controller to Betaflight Configurator over USB and open the **Ports** tab.
2. On the row for the UART you wired, switch on **MSP** in the Configuration/MSP column. Leave the baud rate at **115200**.
3. Click **Save and Reboot**.

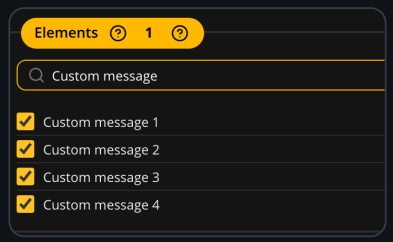
Menu names can shift slightly between Configurator versions. The setting you need is "MSP on that UART at 115200 baud". If you must use another speed, set the same value in RecLink under **Network → Baud rate** (advanced mode) and reboot it.



Betaflight Configurator → Ports.

- Switch MSP on for the UART you wired.
- Leave the speed at 115200.

2. Show the four custom message elements



OSD tab → Elements: Custom message 1 to 4 ticked.

- Tick Custom message 1, 2, 3 and 4.

1. Open the **OSD** tab.
2. In the element list, tick **Custom message 1, 2, 3 and 4** (until RecLink writes to them, Betaflight displays their placeholder names). Switch them on in the profile you fly.
3. Drag each of the four into the layout. Each one is an independent element: put them where your goggles have room. A neat column in the left or right third works well.
4. Save. Keep every line within **16 characters**; that is the most Betaflight allows per message.



OSD tab: the four Custom messages in the preview.



PLACEMENT TIP

You only need to place the elements once. RecLink changes their text; Betaflight keeps the position. Keep them away from where you read battery voltage and warnings.

ANALOG OR DIGITAL?

Pick your OSD type in the configurator's OSD tab. Digital (the default) is safe for DJI-style goggles; analog allows the full character set. See chapter 10.

3. Check your AUX channels



Receiver tab: the bar of your switch moves when you flip it.

- AUX 2 moves to 2000 when the switch is flipped.

RecLink reads the transmitter's channels through the flight controller. If you want a switch to start recording or select zones, assign it to a **free AUX channel** in your radio and confirm in Betaflight's **Receiver** tab that the bar moves. RecLink counts channels the same way Betaflight does: **AUX 1 is channel 5**. You do not need a Betaflight mode for these switches. In chapter 8 you will find the right channel by flipping the switch and letting RecLink detect it.

CHAPTER 5

First power-up and the web configurator

Power the quad, join RecLink's Wi-Fi from your phone, and open the configurator. Everything from here on is done in that page.

1. **Remove the propellers**, then power the flight controller from a battery or USB. The RecLink LED lights solid while it boots.
2. **Wait for the portal.** When the board sees the flight controller and the aircraft is **disarmed**, it starts its own Wi-Fi network. The LED shows two short blinks every second while the portal is open.
3. **Join the network** named `RECLINK-XXXX` (the last two bytes of the board's address) on your phone or laptop. The factory password is `reclinkfpv`.
4. **Open** `http://10.0.0.1` in a browser. Your phone may warn that the network has no internet. Stay connected. RecLink does not force a login sheet, so you open the address yourself.
5. **Change the Wi-Fi password** when asked (below). Up to three devices can be connected at once.



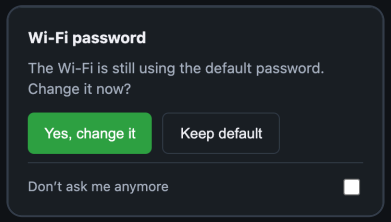
The configurator on a phone.

- RecLink logo. The centre dot turns red and pulses while the camera records.
- Seven tabs. Clock only appears in advanced mode.
- Status card: live link state.
- Firmware version and uptime.

Change the factory password

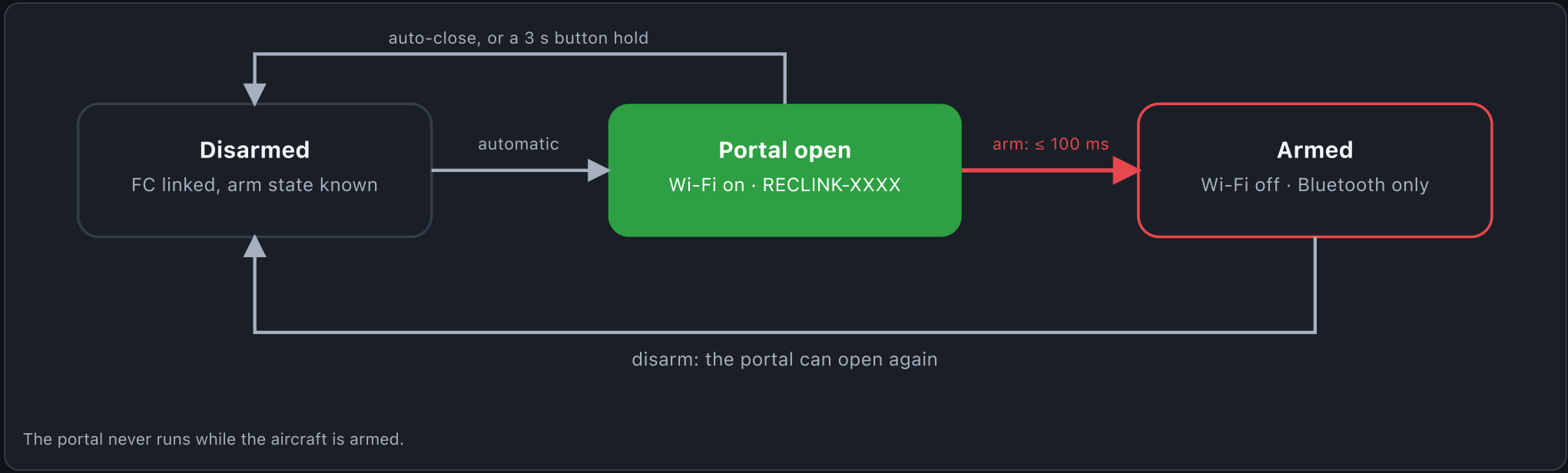
While the password is still the factory default, the configurator shows this prompt each time you open it. Choose **Yes, change it**, type a new password of 8 to 31 characters and press **Save & reboot**. The board restarts and the Wi-Fi comes back with your new password. Tick **Don't ask me anymore** if you want to keep the default; the choice is stored on the board.

> **WRITE IT DOWN**
>
> If you forget the password you can still reach the portal by holding the button for 10 seconds to factory reset. That erases all settings **and** camera pairings.



First-run password prompt.

When the portal opens and closes



The portal never runs while the aircraft is armed.

- **Opens automatically** when the aircraft is disarmed and the flight controller link is up. You can change this to "only after holding the button" in **Network → Open the portal**.
- **Closes** after 15 minutes (adjustable from 1 to 120) once there has also been 60 seconds without activity, or when you hold the button for 3 seconds.
- **Never opens in flight.** If the board reboots mid-flight, it waits until it knows the arm state before it will turn Wi-Fi on.

Using the configurator

TAB	WHAT IT DOES
Status	Live view: aircraft, camera, recording, warnings, camera settings
Cam control	Recording mode, radio switch, zones and camera settings, highlight
OSD	The four OSD lines, preview, warning thresholds
Clock	Camera clock sync (advanced mode only)
Binding	Pair, list and forget cameras
Network	Wi-Fi, flight controller link, radio power, AUX scan
System	Advanced mode, LED, GPS push, reboot, update, reset



After an edit, the bar at the bottom reads "unsaved changes" and its top edge turns green.

- **Nothing applies until you press Save settings.** The bar sticks to the bottom of the screen. When you have unsaved edits it says "unsaved changes". If you try to leave the page with unsaved edits, the browser asks first.
- **Saves are permanent.** They are written to flash before the page confirms. Settings and camera pairings survive a reboot, a power loss and a firmware update.
- **Advanced mode** (System tab) reveals timing fields, diagnostics and the Clock tab. Leave it off while you set up; turn it on when you need to fine-tune. It is remembered on the board.
- **Two settings need a reboot**: the flight controller baud rate / pin swap, and Bluetooth power. After saving one of them a **Reboot now** button appears in the bar.
- **The portal is a bench tool.** The page polls the board every 1.5 seconds. Keep one browser tab open, and close the portal before flying.

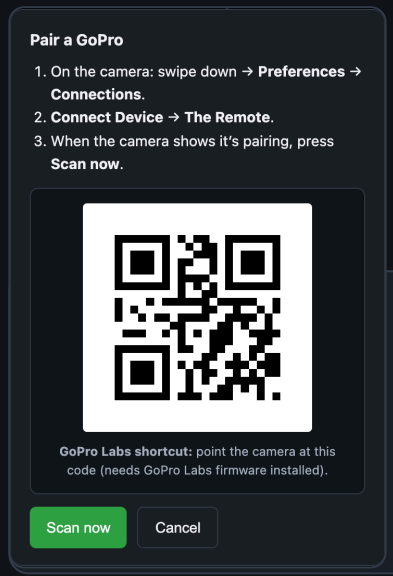
CHAPTER 6

Pairing your camera

Pair once and RecLink reconnects by itself every time you power up. Pairing is done on the **Binding** tab.

GoPro

1. Open the **Binding** tab and press **Pair GoPro**.
2. On the camera, swipe down, then go to **Preferences → Connections → Connect Device → The Remote**.
3. When the camera shows that it is pairing, press **Scan now** in the portal. RecLink listens for up to 45 seconds. It does not connect to anything until you pick.



4. Tap your camera in the list. If more than one GoPro is in pairing mode, check the name and signal strength first.
5. A green check confirms the pairing. The camera appears under **Paired cameras** and its link goes to Connected.

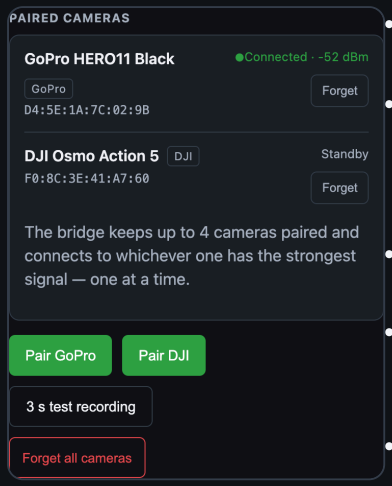
IF NO CAMERA SHOWS UP

The portal says "No GoPro found. Make sure it is in remote-pairing mode, then press Scan now again". Check that the camera is awake and showing its pairing screen. If it is connected to a phone app, disconnect it there first.

Guided GoPro pairing.

- Steps to put the GoPro into remote-pairing mode.
- Optional GoPro Labs shortcut: point the camera at the code. Needs GoPro Labs firmware.
- Cameras found appear here as buttons. Tap yours.
- Start the search after the camera shows it is pairing.

Managing paired cameras



Binding tab with two paired cameras.

- Paired cameras with brand, address and state badge.
- Pair another camera. The buttons disable at four.
- Record for 3 seconds to prove the link works.
- Forget one camera.

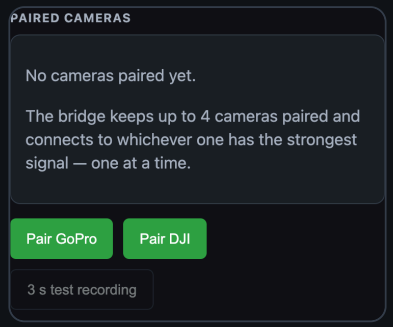
- **Up to four cameras**, any mix of GoPro and DJI. Pairing a new one keeps the others.
- **One at a time.** At power-up RecLink scans for every paired camera and connects to the strongest signal after about 2.5 seconds, or at once to one stronger than −50 dBm.
- **Badges:** ● Connected · −52 dBm, Connecting…, or Standby for a paired camera that is not in use.
- **3 s test recording** starts the connected camera for three seconds. Use it to prove the whole chain works. It only runs while disarmed.
- **Forget** removes one camera. **Forget all cameras** appears when two or more are paired and asks twice.
- **Telemetry poll** (advanced mode) sets how often a GoPro is asked for status: Fast 0.5 s, Normal 1 s or Slow 1.5 s. Normal is right for most setups.

DJI Osmo

1. On the **Binding** tab press **Pair DJI**. The portal shows "pairing… put the DJI into pairing mode now".
2. Put the Osmo into its pairing mode. On a first pairing the camera shows a confirmation prompt on its screen. **Accept it.**
3. RecLink connects to the first matching DJI it hears. After this, reconnecting is automatic and needs no confirmation.

WHEN A BOND IS LOST

If the camera forgets RecLink (you reset its connections, or re-paired it to a phone), the next reconnects fail. After three failures RecLink forgets that camera's bond and raises a **REPAIR_NEEDED** flag on the Status tab. Pair the camera again.

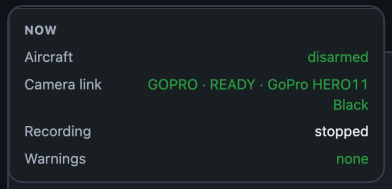


A fresh board has no cameras. Pair one to begin.

CHAPTER 7

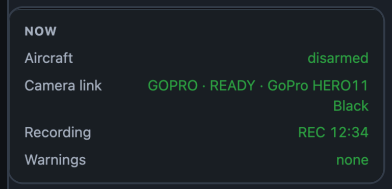
Reading the Status tab

Status is read-only and tells you, at a glance, whether the chain flight controller → RecLink → camera is healthy.



The Now card.

- Aircraft, camera link, recording and warnings.
- Fault flags appear below as chips, if any.



The same card while recording. The logo dot is red and pulses.

NOW

Aircraft	**armed** or **disarmed**, or **FC offline** if the flight controller link is down.
Camera link	Brand, state and name, e.g. GOPRO · READY · GoPro HERO11 Black. States: IDLE, SCAN, CONNECTING, BONDING, SYNCING, READY, LOST.
Recording	**stopped**, or **REC** with elapsed time.
Warnings	The active warning, or none. Same list as the OSD (see chapter 10).

FAULT FLAGS

FC_OFFLINE	No MSP link. Check wiring, UART, baud.
OSD_UNSUPPORTED	Betaflight is older than API 1.47.
REPAIR_NEEDED	Camera bond is missing. Pair again.
CFG_RESET	Stored settings were unreadable. Defaults loaded. Re-pair.
CLOCK_SYNC_FAIL	Clock sync gave up with the time still off.
WDT_RECOVERED	The board restarted after a stall. Tap the chip to acknowledge.



The Details card with a GoPro connected.

- Flight controller, GPS and camera readouts. Blank values mean the camera has not confirmed them.
- Ask the camera for fresh values.

number is worse than none.

DETAILS

- **Flight controller:** Betaflight variant and MSP API version. **OSD grid** is the canvas size the FC reports.
- **GPS:** fix, satellites and whether the fix counts as good. Shown when the FC has a GPS.
- **Camera signal, time left, camera battery, SD card.** SD shows free space in GB, or "NO SD" / "FULL".
- **Mode, resolution, profile** as the camera reports them now.
- **GoPro Video and Protune values:** ISO max/min, shutter angle (for example `180° (1/120)`), Protune, white balance, colour, sharpness, EV comp, 10-bit.
- **Zone settings** is the result of the last zone apply: Zone 1: applied, "partly applied (not accepted: …)", "not applied" or "waiting for camera".

A BLANK IS HONEST

RecLink only shows what the camera confirmed. After a disconnect, every camera value goes blank until the camera answers again. That is deliberate: a stale or guessed

With **Advanced mode** on, a **Diagnostics** card adds the live AUX channel values in µs, error counters and three collapsible debug panels (MSP link, Bluetooth connection, record trigger). They are useful for support, and for finding the stick position of a switch.



With no flight controller link the page says FC offline and the readouts go blank.



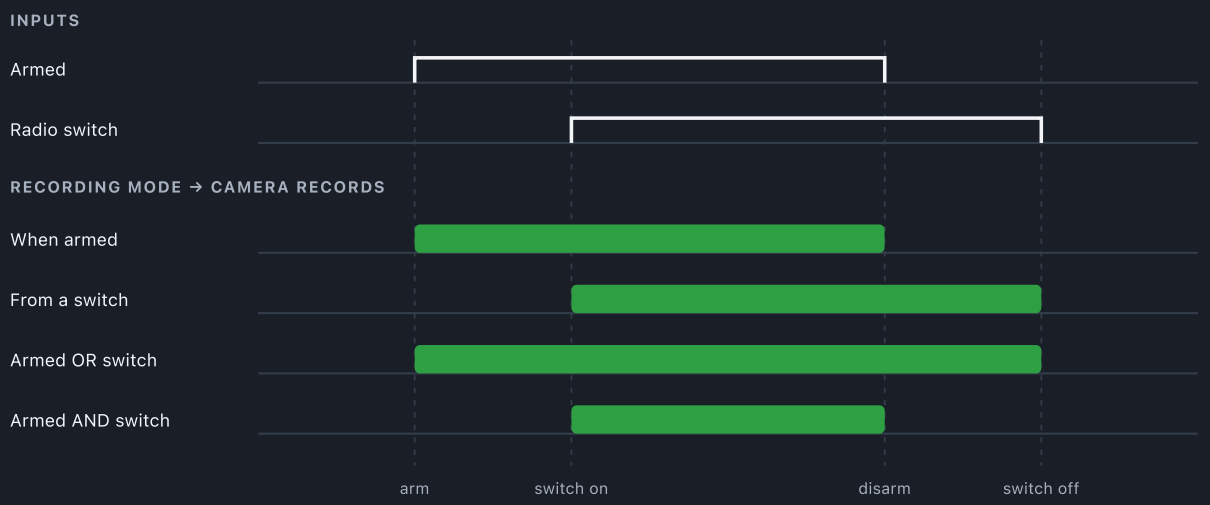
Diagnostics card (advanced mode).

CHAPTER 8

Recording control

Decide what starts and stops the camera. Everything here is on the **Cam control** tab, in the Recording card.

Choose a recording mode



Example: the aircraft arms at 2, the switch goes on at 4, the aircraft disarms at 8 and the switch goes off at 10. Start and stop delays are left out.

MODE	RECORDS WHEN	GOOD FOR
Never (manual only)	Never. You start the camera by hand.	Bench work, or if you use the camera's own controls
When the aircraft is armed	From arm to disarm.	The simple default: every flight is recorded
From a radio switch	While the switch is on, or toggled by a button.	Choosing exactly when to film
Armed OR switch on	Armed, or the switch is on. While armed, turning the switch off cuts the clip, and turning it on again starts a new one.	Always film flights, but cut dead time
Armed AND switch on	Only when both are true. Releasing either one stops the clip at once.	Film only when armed *and* you want it

Set up the radio switch

1. Pick **From a radio switch**, **Armed OR switch on** or **Armed AND switch on**. The Radio switch box becomes active. With *Never* or *When the aircraft is armed* it is greyed out and marked "not applicable".

2. **Find the channel.** Press **Set AUX**, then flip the switch on your transmitter. The label changes to "push button or switch" while it listens. RecLink watches the live channel data, picks whichever channel moves by 200 µs or more, and fills in the AUX field. It gives up after 15 seconds. This needs the flight controller link to be up.

3. **Choose Trigger type. Switch** mirrors the switch: on means recording, off means stop. **Button** is for a spring-loaded control: each press toggles recording and releasing does nothing.

4. **Check the threshold.** The bar shows the control's live position as an amber line. The default of **1700 µs** suits most 3-position switches (the top position counts as on). Adjust it by dragging the handle or typing a value from 900 to 2100.

5. **Press Save settings** and try the switch. The Status tab shows "REC" and the logo dot turns red.

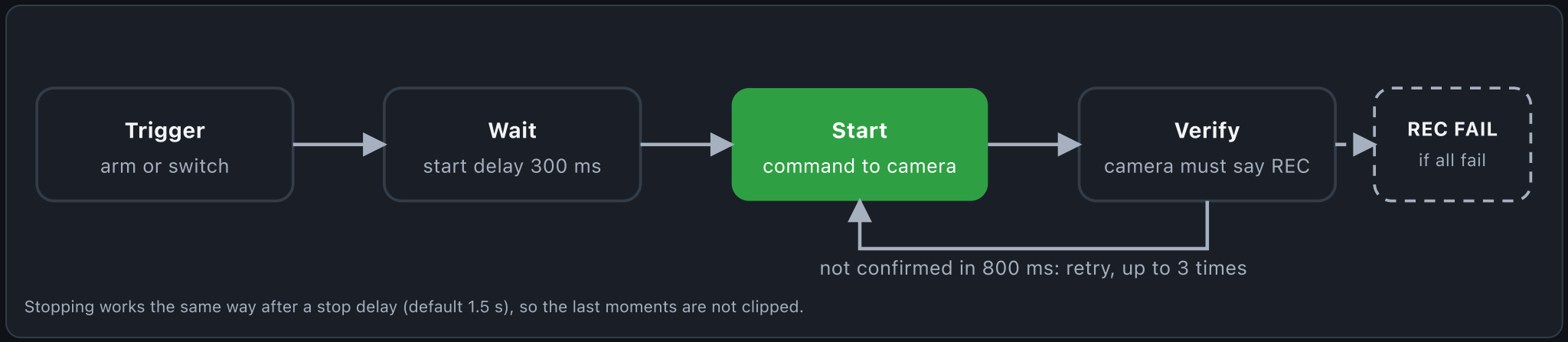
> **PREFER TO LOOK AT THE NUMBERS?**
>
> Network → **Scan AUX now** lists the live value of every AUX channel. Move your switch and press it again to see which channel changed.



Recording card with a radio switch mode selected.

- The recording mode.
- Switch (level) or Button (each press toggles).
- Which AUX channel carries the control.
- Detect the channel by moving the control.
- Live position bar. The thin amber line is the control right now.
- The switch counts as on above this value.

What happens when you trigger it



Stopping works the same way after a stop delay (default 1.5 s), so the last moments are not clipped.

The camera is the judge: RecLink starts it, then waits for the camera to report it is recording. If it does not within the verify window, RecLink retries. If every try fails the OSD warning **REC FAIL** appears. The bridge tracks its own last command, so a camera that fails to report cannot cancel a stop RecLink owes it.

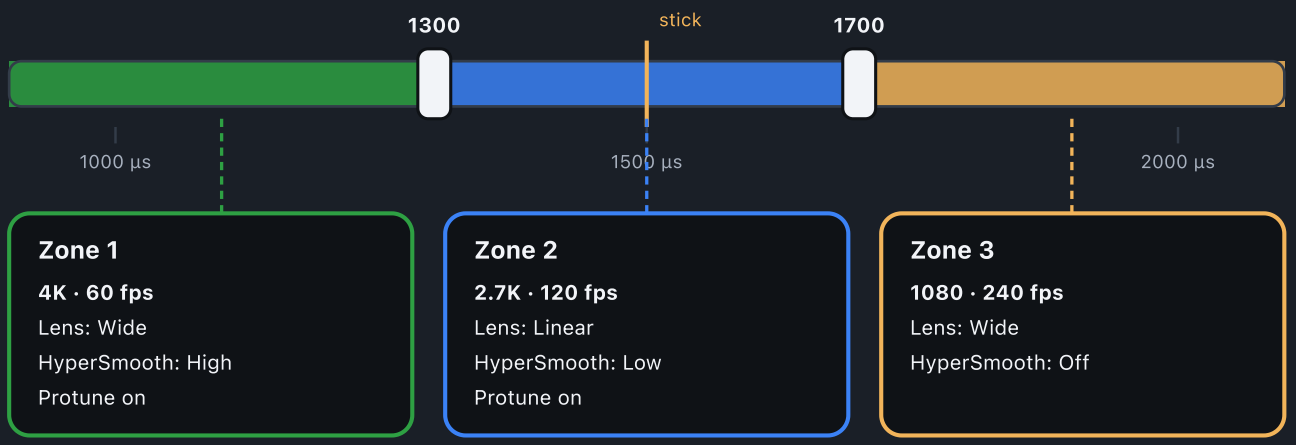
TIMING (ADVANCED MODE)

SETTING	DEFAULT	RANGE	WHAT IT DOES
Start delay after trigger	300 ms	0–10000	Waits before sending start. Lets arming settle.
Keep recording after trigger clears	1500 ms	0–20000	Delays the stop so the landing is captured.
Wait for camera to confirm	800 ms	100–5000	Per attempt.
Retries if not confirmed	3	0–10	Then REC FAIL.

CHAPTER 9

Zones: camera settings from a switch

A 2–6 position switch or knob on your radio picks a **zone**. Each zone stores the camera settings you want, and RecLink sends them to the camera when the stick rests in that zone.



Example settings for a GoPro. The zone applies once the stick has rested in it for the hold time (400 ms).

A three-position switch split into three zones. The bar spans 900 to 2100 µs.

GOPRO AND DJI WORK DIFFERENTLY

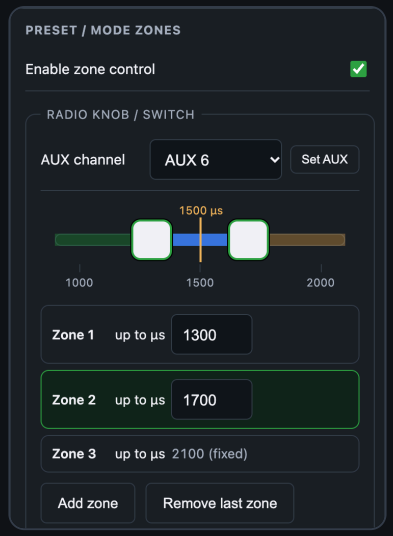
GoPro: a zone does not load a GoPro preset. It pushes the settings you ticked (resolution, frame rate, lens and so on) to the camera's current video preset.
DJI: each zone applies a camera **Mode ID** number instead, typed into a field on the zone row.

Build the zones

1. Tick **Enable zone control**.
2. Choose the **AUX channel** or press **Set AUX** and move the switch.
3. **Add or remove zones** until the count matches your switch (3 for a 3-position switch). New edges are spread out by default: 1300 and 1700 µs for three zones.
4. Move the stick through each position and check the bar's amber cursor lands in the right zone. Adjust the edges by dragging the handles. Edges stay in order and at least 25 µs apart. The last zone always ends at 2100 µs.
5. Build the settings for each zone as shown on the next page.

HOLD TIME

A zone must be held for 400 ms before it is applied, so a quick sweep through the middle does not fire every zone on the way. Change it under **Advanced → Hold time before applying** (50–5000 ms).

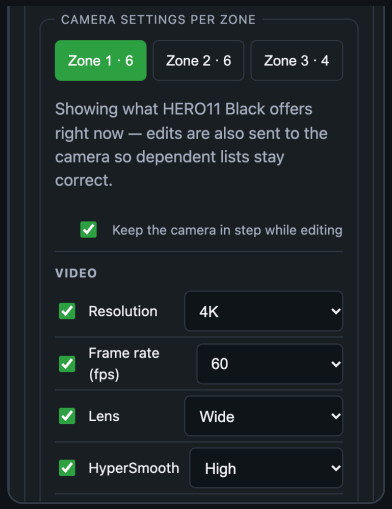


Zone setup, top half of the card.

- Master switch for zone control.
- The AUX channel that carries the knob. Use Set AUX like before.
- The bar splits the 900–2100 µs range into coloured zones. Drag the handles to move the edges.
- One row per zone with its upper edge in µs. The zone the stick is in is tinted green.
- Add or remove a zone, from 2 to 6.

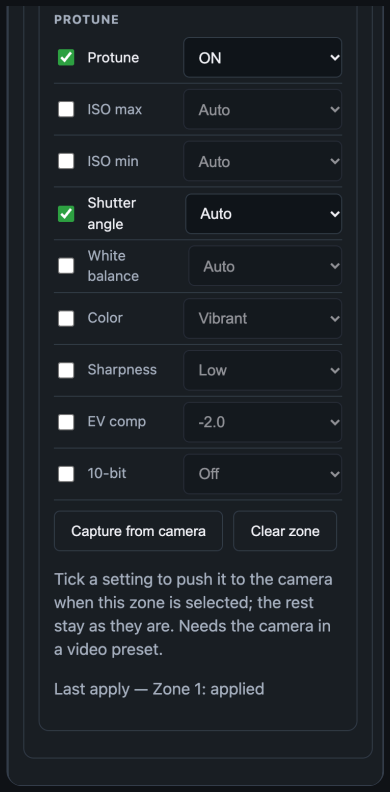
Camera settings for each zone (GoPro)

Below the zone rows, one tab per zone shows a row for every setting a zone can change. **Tick a row to push that setting; leave it unticked and the camera keeps its own value.** Unticked rows are not stored.



Zone settings builder: zone tabs and the Video group.

- One tab per zone. Selecting a tab shows that zone's settings, and applies it to the camera.
- With this on, edits are written to the camera as you make them so the option lists match.
- Each row: tick box, label, option list.



The Protune group and the buttons below.

- Capture from camera fills the zone with the camera's current values. Clear zone empties it.

When a zone is applied

- RecLink applies a zone only when the camera link is ready, the camera is not busy, and it is **not recording**. To allow changes mid-recording, tick **Allow zone changes while recording** in the advanced options.
- If a blocker is in the way it retries on the next tick, without losing the choice.
- After a reconnect, the last selected zone is applied once, in case you changed the camera by hand.

BEHAVIOUR TO KNOW

- **The lists follow the camera.** With the camera connected and in a video preset, each option list shows only what it accepts right now (for example, only the frame rates valid at the current resolution). A value the camera no longer offers stays visible, marked "(not available now)".
- **Order matters and is handled for you.** RecLink writes resolution first, then the settings that depend on it, and Protune before its sub-settings. It waits for the camera to accept each write, checks the result, and retries a refused write once.
- **Shutter is a shutter angle.** 180° means an exposure of 1/(2 × frame rate). The zone keeps the same angle if you change the frame rate.
- **Keep the camera in step while editing** (on by default) means the camera really changes as you edit and as you select zone tabs. It works only while disarmed and not recording. Turn it off to edit without touching the camera.
- **Models differ.** Aspect ratio, Bit depth and Color profile are hidden for a HERO11 because it does not have them. A HERO12 or 13 shows them.

GROUP	SETTINGS A ZONE CAN PUSH
Video	Resolution, Aspect ratio, Frame rate, Lens, HyperSmooth, Bit depth, Color profile
Protune	Protune on/off, ISO max, ISO min, Shutter angle, White balance, Color, Sharpness, EV comp, 10-bit

- The Status tab's **Zone settings** row tells you the result: applied, partly applied (and which settings the camera refused), or not applied. The camera, not RecLink, decides what it accepts. Some options are not valid with the current resolution.
- A zone with no ticked settings pushes nothing.

EXAMPLE

Zone 1 for cruising: 4K, 60 fps, Wide, HyperSmooth High. Zone 2 for a slow-motion pass: 2.7K, 120 fps, Linear. Zone 3 for max frame rate: 1080, 240 fps. Flip the switch in flight and the camera follows once the stick has rested for 400 ms.

CHAPTER 10

OSD: camera info in your goggles

RecLink writes four lines of text, up to 16 characters each, into the four custom message elements you placed in chapter 4.



TEMPLATE

%st %et
state and elapsed time

%bi%bt %wr
battery icon, %, warning

%rs%fp %ln
resolution, fps, lens

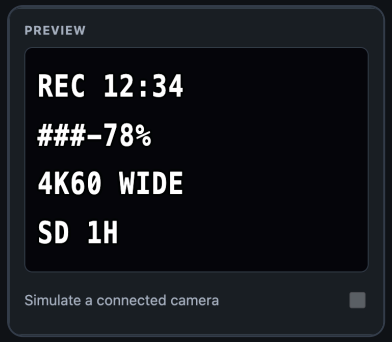
SD %sd
literal text + SD left

Each line is a **template**: normal text plus `%` tokens that RecLink replaces with live values. The defaults are shown here.

Anything the camera has not confirmed is replaced by nothing at all.

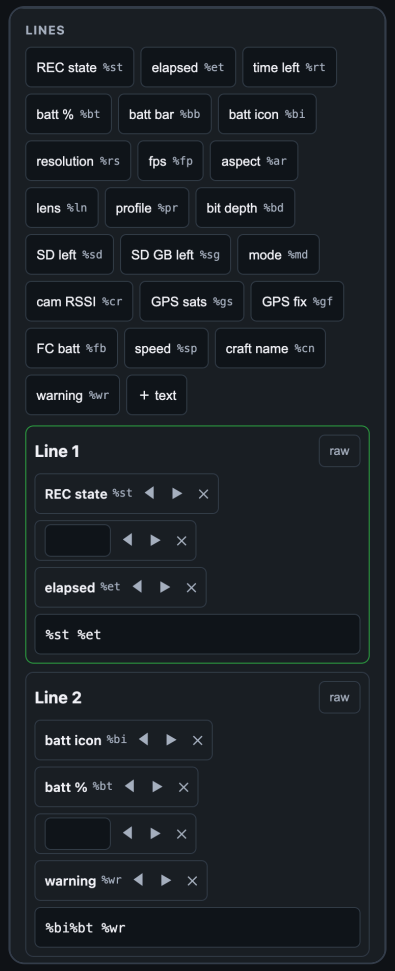
Empty lines are sent as a single space so Betaflight does not show the placeholder name.

Edit the lines



Live preview.

- A preview drawn the way the firmware formats it. It switches to live data once a camera is connected.
- Simulate a camera to design lines while nothing is connected.



The line editor.

- Tap a token to add it to the selected line.
- Each line is a row of chips. The selected line has a green border.
- Raw switches to plain text for the line.
- Chips can be moved with the arrows or removed with the cross.

1. **Tap a line** to select it (green border), then **tap tokens** in the palette to add them. Tap **+ text** to add literal text such as `SD` or `BAT`.
2. Watch the preview. If a line would be longer than 16 characters the page warns "Line N is X chars, clipped to ...". Shorten it.
3. Prefer **raw** if you like typing templates directly, for example `%st %et`. Press **Save settings**.

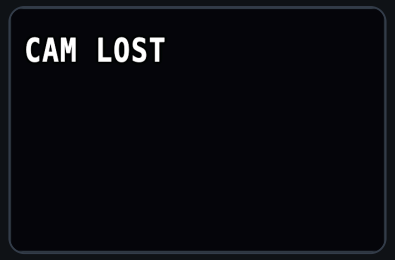
OSD type, rate and units

SETTING	DEFAULT	WHAT IT DOES
OSD type	Digital	**Digital** keeps only glyphs DJI-style goggles draw: letters (uppercased), digits and basic punctuation. Battery bars become `#` and `-`. **Analog** leaves the text alone and allows the full character set, including a battery icon.
Update rate	4 Hz	1–10 Hz. A change takes full effect after a reboot.
Speed units	Metric	Affects the `%sp` token only: km/h or mph.

Warnings

The token `%wr` shows the single most important active warning. A line with `%wr` in it makes the warning visible without a separate element.

WHEN THE CAMERA IS LOST



Camera not connected: slot 1 shows CAM LOST and the rest go blank.

If the camera link is not ready, line 1 reads **CAM LOST**, or a blinking **CAM ?** while RecLink is still searching or connecting. Lines 2–4 go blank. This layout always shows, whatever your warning settings say, so the OSD is never silently stale.

PRIORITY	SHOWS	WHEN
1	CAM LOST	Camera link is not ready
2	**NO SD**	No card in the camera
3	**SD FULL**	Card is full
4	**REC FAIL**	Record command not confirmed after all retries
5	**LOW BATT**	Camera battery at or below the threshold (default 15 %)
6	**SD LOW**	Remaining recording time at or below the threshold (default 3 min)
7	**HOT**	GoPro reports overheating
8	**CLK FAIL**	Clock sync gave up

- **Blink warnings** (default on) flashes the warning twice a second to catch your eye.
- **Show a warning when the camera link is lost** controls the warning shown by `%wr`. Line 1 still shows CAM LOST regardless.
- Set the battery and SD thresholds to taste on the OSD tab. Use 0 to disable one.

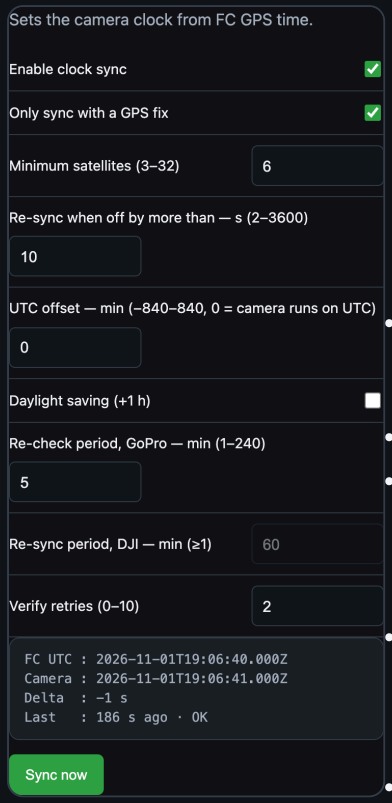
The full list of tokens is in appendix A.

CHAPTER 11

Clock sync, GPS push and highlight tags

Three smaller features that make your footage easier to sort and use.

Camera clock sync



Clock tab (advanced mode).

- Master switch. On by default.
- Minimum satellites for a trusted fix.
- Sync immediately.

RecLink sets the camera's clock from the flight controller's GPS time, so every clip is stamped correctly, even after a battery swap that reset the camera to a default date. It writes to the **camera** only and never to the flight controller's clock.

IT SYNCS WHEN ALL OF THESE ARE TRUE

- Clock sync is on, and (by default) the FC has a GPS with a steady 3D fix and at least 6 satellites for 10 seconds.
- The FC reports a plausible time.
- The camera is connected, not recording and not busy.

WHEN IT RUNS

- When the camera connects, when the GPS fix becomes good, when you press **Sync now**, and then periodically (a GoPro every 5 minutes by default, a DJI every 60).
- For a GoPro it first reads the camera clock and only writes if it is more than 10 seconds off, then checks the result. A DJI cannot be read, so its time is simply sent.

Set **UTC offset** in minutes (and **Daylight saving**) if you want footage in local time. Leave it at 0 for UTC.

If the clock cannot be fixed after the retries, the OSD shows **CLK FAIL** and the Clock tab reports FAILED. Only the timestamp is affected.

DJI GPS position push

For a DJI camera only. On **System → Send aircraft GPS position to the camera**, RecLink streams the aircraft's GPS position to the Osmo at 1 or 2 Hz for the camera's own overlay or metadata. It needs a good GPS fix and valid time. A GoPro ignores this setting.

Highlight tag



Highlight tag (advanced mode).

A spare switch can drop a marker into the footage at a moment you want to find later. Choose its **AUX channel** (use **Set AUX**). When the channel rises above **1700 µs**, RecLink sends a **HiLight** tag to a GoPro. A DJI has no highlight tag, so RecLink presses its **Quick-Switch** button instead.

It works only while the camera link is ready. A momentary push-button is ideal.

CHAPTER 12

Network, System and firmware updates

The housekeeping tabs: Wi-Fi, the link to the flight controller, radio power, and the board's maintenance actions.

Network tab

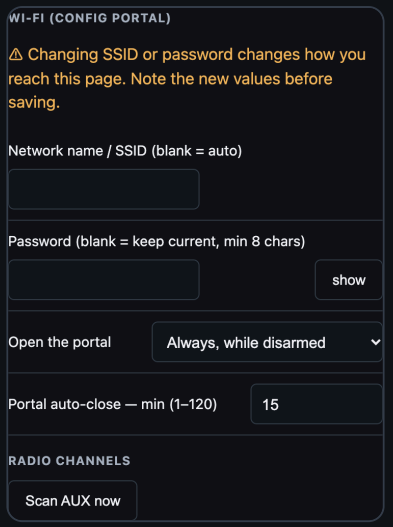
BEFORE YOU SAVE A NEW SSID OR PASSWORD

Changing either one changes how you reach the page. Note the new values first. They apply the next time the portal starts.

SETTING	DEFAULT	NOTES
SSID	blank	Up to 19 characters.
Password	reclinkfpv	Change it. Open network if shorter than 8.
Open the portal	Always, while disarmed	Or "Only after holding the button" (3 s).
Portal auto-close	15 min	1–120. Also needs 60 s with no client.
Wi-Fi channel (adv.)	0 (auto)	1–13.

ADVANCED NETWORK SETTINGS

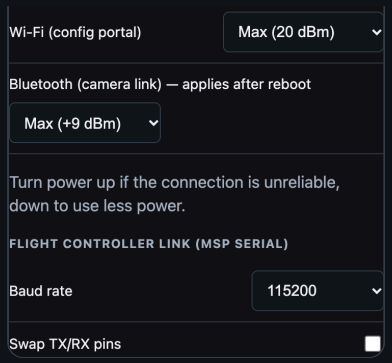
- **Radio power.** Wi-Fi: Low 2 dBm, Medium 10 dBm, Max 20 dBm (default). Bluetooth: Low –12 dBm, Medium 0 dBm, Max +9 dBm (default). Raise power if the connection is unreliable, lower it to use less. Wi-Fi power applies the next time the portal opens. Bluetooth power applies after a reboot.
- **Baud rate** (9600 to 460800, default 115200). Change this only if you changed the flight controller's UART speed, or to work around a marginal link. Both ends must match.
- **Swap TX/RX pins** fixes crossed wires without soldering.
- Both need a reboot. After saving, a **Reboot now** button appears in the bar. Nothing else here needs one.



Network tab, basic mode.

- Wi-Fi network name. Blank gives RECLINK-XXXX.
- Wi-Fi password. Blank keeps the current one. 8–31 characters.
- When the portal opens.
- Lists every AUX channel's live value.

Scan AUX now prints the current value of AUX 1–14 in µs. Move a switch and scan again to see which channel changed. It reads the same data as Set AUX, so it needs the flight controller link.



Radio power and flight controller link (advanced mode).

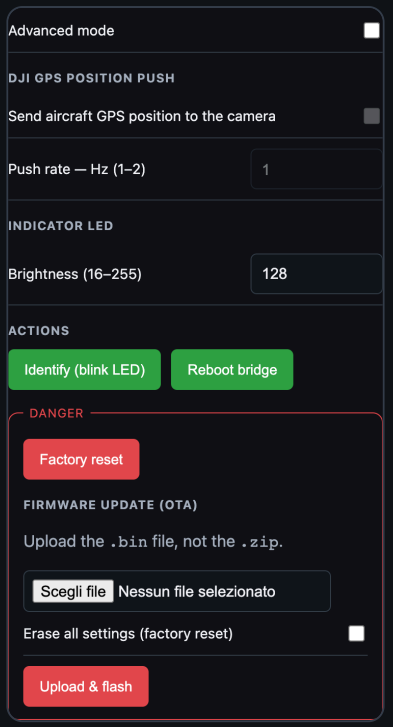
- MSP baud rate. Must match the FC's UART.
- Swap TX and RX if the wires were crossed.
- Bluetooth power. Applies after a reboot.

System tab

Advanced mode	Shows timing options, diagnostics, the Clock tab and the log.
DJI GPS push	See chapter 11.
LED brightness	16–255. Only affects a colour LED; a plain LED cannot dim.
Identify	Blinks the LED for 3 s. Same as a short button press.
Reboot bridge	Restarts RecLink. Settings and pairings are kept. The portal drops for about 10 s.

UPDATE THE FIRMWARE (OTA)

1. Get the firmware **.bin** file. Not the `.zip`.
2. Under **Danger → Firmware update**, choose the file. Tick **Erase all settings** only if you want a clean start.



System tab.

- Advanced mode.
- Blink the LED for 3 seconds to find the board.
- Erase everything.
- Choose the firmware file.

3. Press **Upload & flash** and confirm. A progress bar shows the upload. Do not power off.
4. The board reboots by itself and the page reloads. Settings and pairings are kept unless you chose to erase.

A bad image is rejected and the current firmware stays. The new firmware must start cleanly once before it is accepted, so a faulty update does not stick.

FACTORY RESET

Erases **all settings and all camera pairings**, then reboots. Use the button on the System tab (it asks twice), or hold the board's button for 10 seconds. It is refused while the aircraft is armed. A normal reboot never clears anything.

CHAPTER 13

Flying with RecLink

Once set up, RecLink does its job without you touching it. This chapter is the routine: check before, know what you are seeing during, and what happens if something drops.

REMEMBER

RecLink 0.2.0 has not been flight tested. Bench-test every function with props off, as below, and keep your first flights short and over open ground.

Bench check, props off

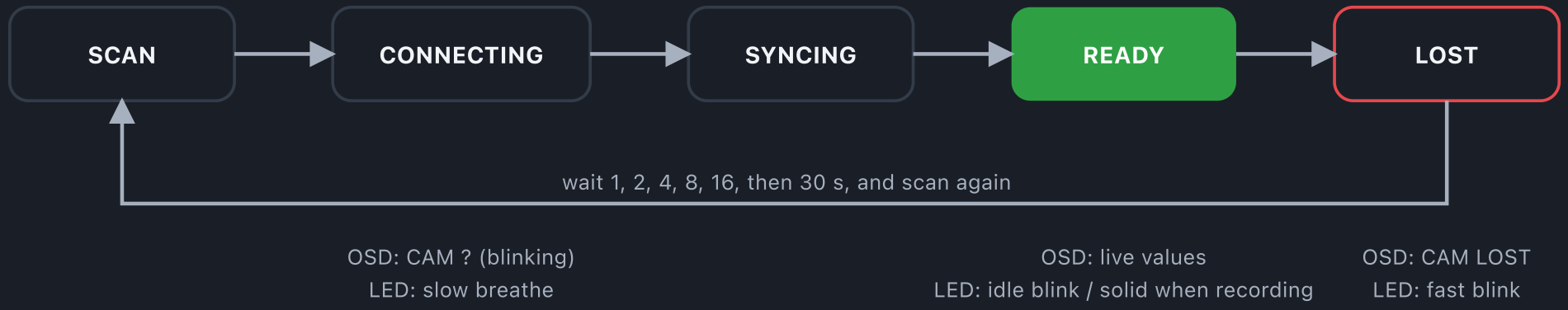
	STEP	YOU SHOULD SEE
☐	Power the quad. Wait a few seconds.	LED: two short blinks per second (portal open), then idle blink once the camera is ready.
☐	Open the portal. Look at the Status tab.	Aircraft: disarmed. Camera link: READY, in green. Battery and SD readouts are filled in.
☐	Look at the goggles.	The four lines show the camera's state, not **CAM LOST**.
☐	Binding tab: 3 s test recording.	The camera records for 3 seconds. OSD shows REC.
☐	Flip the zone switch through every position.	Status shows "Zone N: applied" and the OSD resolution and fps change.
☐	Flip the record switch (if used).	The camera starts and stops. OSD shows REC and the elapsed time.
☐	Close the portal, then **arm** with props off.	The Wi-Fi network vanishes. The camera starts recording after the start delay. LED is solid.
☐	**Disarm.**	The camera stops after the stop delay. The Wi-Fi can come back.
☐	Check camera battery and SD space.	Enough for the flight. The OSD will warn at 15 % and 3 minutes by default.

What you see in the air

- **Wi-Fi is off.** Only Bluetooth runs, so the camera link is as stable as it can be.
- **The OSD text updates** at its set rate. Recording state and elapsed time are always one glance away.
- **The LED** is solid while recording.
- Pressing the button in flight does nothing harmful.

IF SOMETHING DROPS

- **Camera link lost** (out of range, camera off, radio dropout): OSD shows **CAM LOST**, the LED blinks fast, and RecLink keeps trying with growing pauses (1, 2, 4, 8, 16, then every 30 seconds). When it reconnects it checks what the camera is doing and sends at most one corrective command.
- **Flight controller link lost:** RecLink stops writing text. The aircraft is unaffected.
- **RecLink restarts** (brown-out or stall): the OSD text freezes for about 0.3 seconds, then recovers. The camera reconnects by itself.



The camera link lifecycle. SCAN, CONNECTING and SYNCING show as one searching state.

CHAPTER 14

Troubleshooting

Start with the LED and the Status tab. They tell you which of the two links, flight controller or camera, is the problem.

Find the link that is down

YOU SEE	IT MEANS	GO TO
LED: 2 short blinks every 2 s	No flight controller link	Flight controller
LED: fast blink	Camera link lost	Camera
LED: slow breathe	Searching for the camera	Camera
LED: 1 short blink every 3 s	Everything is fine, idle	—

Wi-Fi and the configurator

PROBLEM	TRY
I cannot see the RECLINK network	The portal only runs while **disarmed** and with the flight controller link up. Check the aircraft is disarmed and the LED shows two quick blinks per second. Hold the board's button for 3 seconds to open it by hand. It also closes after 15 minutes idle, so hold again if it went away.
I joined, but the page will not load	Type `http://10.0.0.1` in the address bar. Stay connected even if the phone warns about no internet. Turn off mobile data if the phone keeps switching away. Up to three devices can connect at once.
The password is rejected	The factory password is `reclinkfpv`. If you changed it and lost it, hold the button for 10 seconds to factory reset. That also erases camera pairings.
My changes disappeared	Press **Save settings**. Changes apply and persist only after saving. The bar says "unsaved changes" until you do.

Flight controller and OSD

PROBLEM	TRY
Status shows FC offline	Check wiring: FC TX to RecLink RX and FC RX to RecLink TX. Check MSP is enabled on that UART at 115200. Try **Swap TX/RX pins** (advanced), save and reboot. If you changed the baud, match it on both sides.
OSD shows nothing from RecLink	Confirm Betaflight is **2025.12 or newer**, and that Custom message 1–4 are enabled and placed in the OSD tab. An **OSD_UNSUPPORTED** chip means the API is too old.
Placeholder names instead of text	The line is empty or RecLink is not connected yet. Check the FC link first.
OSD symbols look wrong	Match **OSD type** to your goggles. Digital filters to plain letters and digits. Use analog only for an analog OSD chip.
A line is cut off	Lines are limited to 16 characters. Shorten the template. The preview warns you.
The board resets in flight	Check the 5 V supply. Add a 220 µF or larger capacitor across the board's power pads. Watch for **WDT_RECOVERED** or a rising reboot counter in Diagnostics.

Camera

PROBLEM	TRY
The camera is not found when pairing	GoPro: put it in **Connections → Connect Device → The Remote** first, then press Scan now. Disconnect it from any phone app. Move RecLink closer. Make sure fewer than four cameras are already paired.
"Bond list full"	Four cameras are the limit. Forget one on the Binding tab.
REPAIR_NEEDED chip, or the camera never reconnects	The camera forgot RecLink, usually after its connections were reset. Forget it on the Binding tab, then pair it again.
It connects, then drops again and again	Move the board away from carbon and battery leads. In Network (advanced) raise Bluetooth power to Max and reboot. After three silent hangs in two minutes RecLink reboots itself to clear the link.
CAM LOST on the OSD	The camera is off, asleep, out of range or has dropped the link. Turn it on and wait; RecLink retries on its own.
Values on Status are blank	The camera has not confirmed them yet. Press **Refresh camera state**. Blank means unknown, on purpose.

Recording and zones

PROBLEM	TRY
It does not record on arm	Check **Start / stop recording** is set to a mode that includes arm, and the Status tab shows the aircraft as armed. Check the camera has a card and is connected (READY).
REC FAIL on the OSD	The camera did not confirm recording. Check the SD card and that the camera is not busy. In advanced mode, raise **Wait for camera to confirm** or **Retries**. Open the Record trigger debug panel to see the last command.
The switch does nothing	Use **Set AUX** again. Check the amber cursor on the bar moves when you flip it, and that the threshold sits between the off and on positions. For a push-button choose Trigger type: Button.
Zones do not change the camera	Check Enable zone control, the right AUX channel, and that the camera is in a **video** preset and not recording. Wait for the hold time (400 ms). Read the Zone settings row on Status.
"partly applied (not accepted: ...)"	The camera refused those settings. Some options are not valid together, for example a frame rate with the chosen resolution. Pick values the lists offer, and use Capture from camera to start from a known-good combination.
Footage has the wrong date	Clock sync needs a GPS fix with enough satellites and a camera that is idle and connected. See the Clock tab and press Sync now.

STILL STUCK

With **Advanced mode** on, the System tab shows a short log and the Status tab shows counters and three debug panels. A screenshot of those, plus your firmware version from the header, is what you need when asking for help.

APPENDIX A

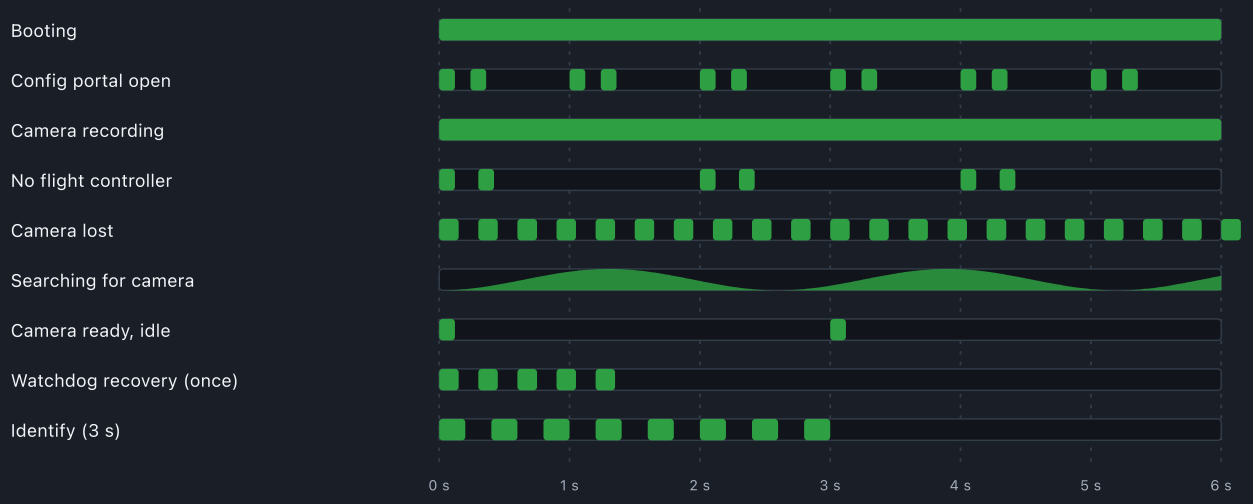
Reference

OSD tokens

TOKEN	SHOWS	LOOKS LIKE
`%st`	Recording state	REC · IDLE · PRE · ----
`%et`	Elapsed recording time	12:34
`%rt`	Remaining recording time	45m · 1h
`%bt`	Camera battery percent	78%
`%bb`	Camera battery bar, 4 characters	###-
`%bi`	Battery icon (analog) or the 4-character bar (digital)	###-
`%rs`	Resolution	4K
`%fp`	Frame rate	60
`%ln`	Lens	WIDE
`%ar`	Aspect ratio	16:9
`%pr`	Colour profile	STD · LOG · HDR · HLG
`%bd`	Bit depth	8b · 10b
`%md`	Camera mode name	VID
`%sd`	SD space: minutes, hours or GB; NO SD; FULL	1h · 45m · 32G
`%sg`	SD free space always in GB	39.3G
`%cr`	Camera link signal in dBm	-52
`%wr`	Active warning (chapter 10)	LOW BATT
`%cn`	Craft name from the FC	QUAD1
`%gs`	GPS satellite count	14
`%gf`	GPS fix	3D · NO
`%fb`	Flight battery state from the FC	OK · LOW · CRIT
`%sp`	Ground speed (units setting)	62KMH · 38MPH

Any other `%` code is printed as typed. Normal text passes through unchanged. In digital mode everything is uppercased.

Status LED



What a single-colour LED does over a six-second window.

Timings are nominal. On the production board the LED is a single-colour LED, so patterns differ by rhythm only. Boards with an addressable LED use colour too (blue for the portal, green for recording). The LED shows the highest-priority pattern that applies: portal, then a recent watchdog recovery, then recording, then flight controller down, then the camera link state. Identify overrides everything while it runs.

Factory defaults

SETTING	DEFAULT
Start / stop recording	When the aircraft is armed
Record switch	Switch type, no channel assigned, on above 1700 µs
Start delay · stop delay · verify · retries	300 ms · 1500 ms · 800 ms · 3
Zone control	Off. Three zones at 1300 / 1700 / 2100 µs. Hold time 400 ms. No changes while recording.
Highlight channel	None
OSD	Digital · 4 Hz · metric · lines `%st %et`, `%bi%bt %wr`, `%rs%fp %ln`, `SD %sd`
OSD warnings	Battery 15 % · SD 3 min · blink on · show lost on
Clock sync	On · needs GPS · 6 satellites · 10 s tolerance · UTC · GoPro check every 5 min · DJI resync every 60 min · 2 retries
DJI GPS push	Off · 1 Hz
Wi-Fi	SSID RECLINK-XXXX · password reclinkfpv · channel auto · open while disarmed · auto-close 15 min · Max power
Bluetooth power	Max (+9 dBm)

Flight controller link	115200 baud · pins not swapped
LED brightness · Advanced mode	128 · off

At a glance

Wi-Fi network	RECLINK-XXXX
Portal address	`http://10.0.0.1`
Wi-Fi password	`reclinkfpv` (change it)
Max Wi-Fi clients	3
Max paired cameras	4, one connected at a time
Max OSD line length	16 characters, 4 lines

What RecLink can and cannot touch

IT READS

- Flight controller: API version, craft name, arm state, RC channels, GPS, battery state, clock.
- Camera: recording, battery, SD, mode, resolution, frame rate and the other values shown on the Status tab.

IT WRITES

- Four lines of OSD text to the flight controller.
- Record, settings, highlight and clock commands to the camera.

IT NEVER SENDS

- Any RC, GPS, clock, display-port or reboot command to the flight controller.
- Any command that arms or disarms.
- Any formatting, firmware, reset or file-delete command to the camera from automation. Those exist only as labelled portal actions, while disarmed.

Short press	Identify (LED 3 s)
Hold 3 s	Open or close the portal
Hold 10 s	Factory reset (not while armed)
Serial	UART, 8N1, 115200, 3.3 V
Pins	RX GPIO20 · TX GPIO21 · button GPIO9 · LED GPIO10
Betaflight	2025.12.0 or newer (API 1.47+)

Glossary

AUX	A spare radio channel beyond the four sticks. AUX 1 is channel 5.
µs	Microseconds. Channel values run from about 1000 (low) to 2000 (high).
BLE	Bluetooth Low Energy, the link to the camera.
Bond	The stored pairing between RecLink and one camera.
MSP	MultiWii Serial Protocol, the language Betaflight speaks over the wire.
OSD	On-screen display: the text drawn over your video feed.
OTA	Over-the-air firmware update, done from the configurator.
Portal	RecLink's Wi-Fi network and configuration web page.
Zone	A slice of a radio switch's travel that selects a set of camera settings.

RecLink User Guide, firmware 0.2.0 (pre-release). Screenshots show the real configurator with example values. Menu names in Betaflight Configurator and on cameras can differ slightly between versions.